

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/13: BOUNDARY AND POST-MAURYAN DECCAN

- └ After Mauryan contraction, megalithic/local chiefdoms, agrarian settlements and early towns persisted.
- └ Satavahanas formed a long-lived Deccan polity; they did not simply inherit a ready-made Mauryan province.
- └ CORE SPACE: western plateau + Godavari/Krishna corridors + shifting access to Malwa, Konkan and Andhra.
- └ BOUNDARY: Tamilakam's Chera-Chola-Pandya and Sangam corpus belong to Topic 18.
- └ ANSWER SPINE: region → ruler/source → mechanism → social-economic effect → qualification.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/13: NAMES, IDENTITY AND CHRONOLOGY FIREWALL

- └ Puranas: Andhra / Andhra-Bhritya; inscriptions and coins: Satavahana / Satakarni.
- └ Conventional equation is useful, but does not settle ethnicity, language, homeland or one unbroken line.
- └ Simuka = conventional founder; absolute start date and first territorial core remain debated.
- └ Broad order: Simuka → Satakarni I/Naganika → Gautamiputra → Pulumavi → Yajna Sri → later regional end.
- └ Use broad ranges and confidence labels; never harmonize every Puranic ruler into false precision.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/13: SOURCE LADDER AND LIMITS

- └ INSCRIPTIONS: Naneghat, Nashik, Karla/Karle, Kanheri → names, rites, grants, donors, claims.
- └ COINS: rulers, metals, symbols, overstrikes and circulation; findspot ≠ capital or border.
- └ ARCHAEOLOGY: settlements, irrigation, crafts, caves and Amaravati phases; material ≠  
| dynasty automatically.
- └ PURANAS / GATHA SAPTASHATI / PERIPLUS / CLASSICAL NOTICES: layered memory and external  
| description.
- └ METHOD: claim → named evidence → analysis → source-specific qualification → corroboration.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/13: EARLY RULERS, NANEGHAT AND ROYAL RITUAL

- └ Simuka opens the conventional sequence; Kanha/Krishna is linked with early Nashik activity.
- └ Satakarni I + Naganika: Naneghat genealogy, portraits, titles, sacrifices and major dakshina.
- └ Pass joins plateau and Konkan: political display was placed on a route of movement and exchange.
- └ Queen's public agency is secure; matriarchy or female-line succession is not.
- └ Repeated Satakarni names require inscription-specific identification.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/13: GAUTAMIPUTRA, NAHAPANA AND JOGALTHEMBI

- └ Nahapana/Kshaharata power held western routes, caves and coastal connections.
- └ Gautami Balashri's Nashik prashasti praises Gautamiputra as Kshaharata destroyer and wide conqueror.
- └ Jogalthembi hoard: Nahapana silver coins overstruck with Gautamiputra devices and legends.
- └ STRONG INFERENCE: takeover + currency revalidation/reuse; grant context adds fiscal displacement.
- └ LIMIT: no exact battle date, total extermination, permanent frontier or all-reign map.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/13: PULUMAVI, RUDRADAMAN AND SHIFTING GEOGRAPHY

- └ Vashishthiputra Pulumavi: Nashik context plus strong eastern Deccan coin/inscription presence.
- └ Rudradaman's Junagadh prashasti claims two victories over a Satakarni spared because of kinship.
- └ Rivalry + marriage diplomacy coexisted; neither prashasti is a neutral campaign report.
- └ Pratishthana/Paithan = major western centre; Amaravati-Dharanikota = major eastern zone.
- └ Capital, mint, religious centre and inscription findspot must not be collapsed into one category.

## ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/13: ADMINISTRATION AND LAYERED SOVEREIGNTY

- └ AHARA = territorial/revenue-administrative division; boundaries and functions could vary.
- └ AMATYA / MAHAMATRA / MAHASENAPATI / GRAMIKA = officers and local intermediaries.
- └ MAHARATHI / MAHABHOJA = powerful regional chiefs, donors and marriage partners.
- └ Court + officers + chiefs + villages + guilds + religious institutions = network polity.
- └ “Feudatory” is cautious shorthand; evidence does not prove a fixed mature feudal constitution.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/13: AGRARIAN CHANGE, GRANTS AND RURAL SETTLEMENT

- └ Iron tools + paddy transplantation in suitable zones + cotton + wells/tanks → uneven intensification.
- └ Krishna-Godavari wet-rice potential cannot be projected over the entire plateau.
- └ Grants and fiscal immunities transfer revenue/access rights to Brahmanas or religious establishments.
- └ Early grants illuminate institutional change; they do not automatically equal mature feudalism.
- └ Rural surplus supported courts, towns, crafts and donations, but prosperity was socially uneven.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/13: CRAFTS, SHRENIS, TOWNS AND TRADE ROUTES

- └ Ironworking, beads, pottery and textiles appear at Deccan settlement and workshop sites.
- └ SHRENI: occupational organization, identity and financial endowment; not a modern corporation.
- └ Pratishthana + Tagara linked through passes to Kalyana, Sopara and Bharukachchha under shifting control.
- └ Eastern corridors joined inland centres to Krishna-Godavari and Amaravati-Dharanikota.
- └ Routes show connectivity, not continuous Satavahana ownership of every port and segment.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/13: COINAGE, ROMAN CONTACT AND MARITIME CAUTION

- └ Satavahana issues: lead prominent; also potin, copper and some silver; regional legends/symbols.
- └ Overstrikes answer political-monetary questions; ordinary findspots answer circulation questions.
- └ Roman/Mediterranean objects and coins = one strand within wider inland and Indian Ocean exchange.
- └ Yajna Sri ship motifs = maritime symbolism/commercial orientation, not measured fleet or thalassocracy.
- └ Reject both “Roman trade caused all prosperity” and “external trade was irrelevant.”

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/13: SOCIETY, WOMEN, LANGUAGE AND PLURAL RELIGION

- └ Varna-restoration claims = royal Brahmanical ideology, not a demographic census.
- └ Matronymics = maternal gotra/lineage legitimacy within largely patrilineal succession; no matriarchy.
- └ Merchants, artisans, Yavanas, women, monks/nuns and chiefs appear in donor inscriptions.
- └ Prakrit in Brahmi dominates; Gatha Saptashati/Gaha Sattasai is attributed to Hala but layered.
- └ Vedic sacrifice + Brahmanical identity coexisted with Buddhist cave/stupa patronage.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/13: SITES, DONOR NETWORKS, ART AND CONTINUITY

- └ Nashik: rival Kshatrapa/Satavahana records, grants, caves and Gautami Balashri's prashasti.
- └ Karla/Karle + Kanheri: route-linked, multi-donor chaitya-vihara networks; patronage ≠ exclusive creed.
- └ Amaravati: lower Krishna mahachaitya, long multi-phase sequence crossing dynastic boundaries.
- └ Art cross-link: use Amaravati form and circulation, but route detailed style history to Art & Culture.
- └ Decline produced Ikshvaku, Abhira, Chutu and other regional formations with institutional continuity.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/13: UPSC TRAPS AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

- └ TRAPS: Andhra ≠ ethnicity proof; coin ≠ border; prashasti ≠ neutral report; donor ≠ population census.
- └ MATCH: Satakarni I–Naganika–Naneghat | Gautamiputra–Balashri–Nashik–Nahapana overstrikes.
- └ MATCH: Pulumavi–eastern phase | Rudradaman–Junagadh rival claim | Yajna Sri–ship motif.
- └ PARAGRAPH: claim → named inscription/coin/site/text → analysis → qualification.
- └ VERDICT: Satavahana power integrated a diverse Deccan through layered rule, production, routes and plural patronage without uniform control or timeless prosperity.